Ann-Kristin Becker

University of Potsdam

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Regional Economics, Economic History, Development Economics

Current Position & Affiliations

since 2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Chair for Empirical Economics, University of Potsdam

since 2026 **Coordinator**, Center for Economic Policy Analysis, University of Potsdam

since 2026 **Research Associate**, Berlin School of Economics, Berlin

Professional Experience

2025 – 2026 **Research Associate**, Center for Economic Research, University of Cologne

2021 – 2025 **Research Associate**, Institute for Economic Policy at the University of Cologne

2021 **Consultant**, United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, Geneva

2020 – 2021 **Carlo Schmid Fellow**, United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, Geneva

2018 – 2020 **Research Assistant**, German Institute for Development Evaluation, Bonn

Education

since 2021 **Ph.D. Candidate in Economics**, University of Cologne
Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Erik Hornung & Prof. Michael Krause, Ph.D.

Autumn 2024 **Visiting Ph.D. Student**, LSE
Host: Prof. Guy Michaels, Ph.D.

2017 – 2020 **M.Sc. Economics**, University of Cologne

2013 – 2016 **B.Sc. Applied Mathematics**, University of Lübeck

References

Professor Erik Hornung
University of Cologne
hornung@wiso.uni-koeln.de

Professor Michael Krause
University of Cologne
michael.krause@wiso.uni-koeln.de

Professor Guy Michaels
LSE
g.michaels@lse.ac.uk

Scholarships & Awards

2025 – 2026 Ph.D. Scholarship (Center for Economic Research, University of Cologne)
2021 C-SEB Student Award (Center for Social and Economic Behavior, University of Cologne)
2020 – 2021 Carlo Schmid Scholarship (German Academic Scholarship Foundation)
2018 Dean's Award (Faculty of Management, Economics and Social Sciences, University of Cologne)

Working Papers

Industrialization and the Return to Labor: Evidence from Prussia (with E. Hornung)
R&R at Journal of Economic Growth
CEPR Discussion Paper No. 20810; *CESifo Working Paper No. 12237*; *CAGE Working Paper No. 779*; *ECONtribute Discussion Paper No. 378*

Work in Progress (selected)

Production Linkages and Regional Development: Evidence from Coal Mining in Germany
Forced Melting Pot: Temporary Migration and the Formation of Economic and Social Ties (with C. Stapper)

Publications

Vulnerable entrepreneurs' preferences for climate risk management: A discrete choice experiment with micro-enterprises in the Philippines, *Journal of Environmental Management* 392, 126485 (2025). (with G. Leppert & A. Köngeter)

Climate finance commitments in practice: additionality and the adaptation gap, *Climate and Development* 1-6 (2026) (with I. Sieberichs)

Policy Work (selected)

Beyond the Pledge: Addressing Ambiguities in International Climate Finance Agreements, *Global Policy Journal*, 16/12/2025 (with I. Sieberichs)

Warum die internationale Klimafinanzierung mehr Verbindlichkeit braucht, *Makronom*, 19/12/2024 (with I. Sieberichs)

Kontroversen um den Entwicklungshaushalt, *Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung* no. 219, p. 18, 19/09/2024 (with I. Sieberichs) Media coverage: FAZ

Taking Responsibility or Prioritizing Donor Interests? An Assessment of Germany's International Climate Finance, *Wirtschaftsdienst*, 103. Jhg., 2023, Heft 6 (with I. Sieberichs) Media coverage: Frag den Staat, University of Cologne

Eine Kommentierung wagen – Schlaglichter auf den Koalitionsvertrag, *Kölner Impulse zur Wirtschaftspolitik* 01/2022 (with M. Krause, T. Markefke, F. Mindl, C. Oslislo & S.J. Roth)

Compulsory Insurance Against Damage Caused by Natural Disasters, *Wirtschaftsdienst*, 102. Jahrgang, 2022, Heft 1 (with C. Oslislo)

Referee for Journals & Conferences

since 2024 Reviewer for the EAYE Annual Meeting
2021–2025 Referee for the Zeitschrift für Wirtschaftspolitik
2023 Reviewer for the FRESH Meeting, Cologne

Conference & Workshop Presentations

2026 CESifo Junior Workshop on Labor Economics, Munich (Germany); European Meeting of the UEA, Barcelona (Spain); EHS Annual Conference, London (UK)
2025 ASREC, Copenhagen (Denmark); EHES Conference, Hohenheim (Germany); WEHC, Lund (Sweden); 1st CEPR Applied Micro-Economic History Workshop, Heidelberg (Germany)
2024 EC501 LSE Labour Seminar, London (UK); ETRANHET Workshop, Paris (France); EAYE Annual Meeting, Paris (France)
2023 EHA Annual Meeting, Pittsburgh (USA); EHES Conference, Vienna (Austria); FRESH Meeting, Cologne (Germany); EHS Annual Conference, Warwick (UK)
2022 Economic and Social History Seminar, Bonn (Germany)

Teaching

since 2026 Econometrics (lecture, undergraduate), University of Potsdam
2021 – 2024 Economic and financial policy (tutorial, undergraduate), University of Cologne
2022 – 2023 Academic writing in public (project course, undergraduate), University of Cologne
since 2021 Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, University of Cologne & Potsdam

Organizer of Workshops & Seminars

2024 23rd Cologne Economic Policy Dialogue: Is violence (also) an economic problem?
2024 22nd Cologne Economic Policy Dialogue: The future of the German pension system
2023/24 Lecture series: Energy from an economic policy perspective
2022 Science meets practice: Migration from an economic policy perspective

Engagement

since 2023 Scientific support of students in the Young Economic Solutions (YES) program
2024/25: The economy and me – Economic education as a basis for participation in a democratic society
2023/24: Lost Generation – What can we do about the increased educational inequality caused by the Covid-19 pandemic?
2017 – 2018 Educational Worker, Lebenshilfe Köln e.V.

Skills

Languages German (native), English (advanced), Spanish (intermediate)
Programming R, MATLAB, Stata